massacres were highly selective, and he spared the people who in his eyes were experts of art and knowledge.[*] Undoubtedly, this is the same model that Babur and his successors followed. This was not the Mongol or Moghūl case in general.

In India, he captured and ordered the execution of a hundred thousand prisoners to free his soldiers, thereby concretizing his aspiration of Delhi. Of course, within these misfortunes, both Muslims and non-Muslims suffered despite the intention being to target non-Muslims largely. Unlike the general Mongol traditions of governance, Timur ensured systematic persecution on account of religion.[27]

The control of Delhi was one of the very important victories of Timur. And why not? Delhi was one of the richest cities in the world back then.[†] Retaliations began after Delhi fell into his hands. Timur led the Turco-Mongol Army and inflicted widespread bloodshed and massacres against all the retaliations within the city walls. After three days of tussling between resisting forces and the Turco-Mongol Army, it is said that the city smelt of the decomposing bodies of its sons with their heads being placed over one another and the bodies left as food for the birds by Timur's soldiers.[‡] This destruction of Delhi had opened the doors for long-lasting chaos that would consume India for long. The great city of Delhi founded by Anangpal Tomar[§] would not be able to recover from the great loss it suffered for at least centuries.

As stated earlier, Timur was an excellent politician. The precedents that follow would prove this case.

Timur's Turco-Mongolian heritage offered him both prospects and contests. He had all desires to rule the Muslim world, being the head of the Mongol Empire. But the existing Mongol tradition posed outright trouble for his ambition. He was not the direct descendant of Genghis Khān (refer to Figure 1) and hence he couldn't claim the title of 'the Khān' or rule the 'Mongol Empire'.

Henceforth, the cunning Timur set up a puppet in Chaghatay Khān, Suyurghatmish, as the titular ruler of Balkh by pretending to be a 'protector of the member of a Chinggisid line (Genghis Khān's eldest son, Jochi).'[*] At the same time, Timur took up the title of 'Amir'. It was as good as not only being the general but also acting in the name of the Chagatai ruler of Transoxiana.[†]

To underpin this position, Timur further claimed the title 'Guregen' (royal son-in-law) when he married Saray Mulk Khānum, a princess of Chinggisid descent.[‡]

While Timur aspired to rule both the Muslim and Mongol worlds, he could neither take the title of 'Khān' nor he could become the 'Caliph', as the latter's